MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF EDUCATION

DEPARTMENT OF LANGUAGES AND LITERATURE

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS-FEBRUARY, 2018

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: February, 2018 **TIME: 2:00 pm - 4:30 pm**

(2 1/2 hours)

Instructions

(i) Answer **all** questions.

(ii) Write the name of **your lecturer** on top of your answer book.

Question One

A. Chimwemwe and Mayamiko have both referred to a 2012 research paper by J. Gateway entititled 'Development of bilingualism in early childhood' in their essays. Both have cited the source correctly, but one of them has inadvertently plagiarised. The information is found on page 115.

Read the original research paper and Chimwemwe's and Mayamiko's assignments and answer the questions that follow:

Original research paper

In this study, the linguistic development of 24 children living in bilingual homes was monitored between the ages of one and five. Parents were instructed to communicate with the child on in their own first language (L1) in order to ensure similar input in each language. Unlike previous studies (Ralhein 1988; Mirutah and Iwote 1992), it was found that in 62% of cases, the child developed greater proficiency in the mother's L1 by the age of five.

Chimwemwe's assignment

In his study, Gateway (2012) discovered that in 62% of cases, the child developed greater proficiency in the mother's L1 by the age of five.

Mayamiko's assignment

Gateway (2012) conducted a study investigating the effect of bilingual input on language development in children Her findings suggest that the amount of exposure to linguistic input does have an effect on the rate of language development in children.

Questions

(I) Identify the assignment which contains an example of plagiarism. **(2 marks)**

(II) Give a reason for your choice **(4 marks)**

B. Answer the questions below, using the source provided:

Authors: Ben Carson & Gregory Lewis

Year of publication: 2016

Publisher: Zondervan Publishing House

City: Michigan

Title: The Big Picture

(i) Using APA style, show how the information in the source would be presented in an in-text citation in your essay. **(5 marks)**

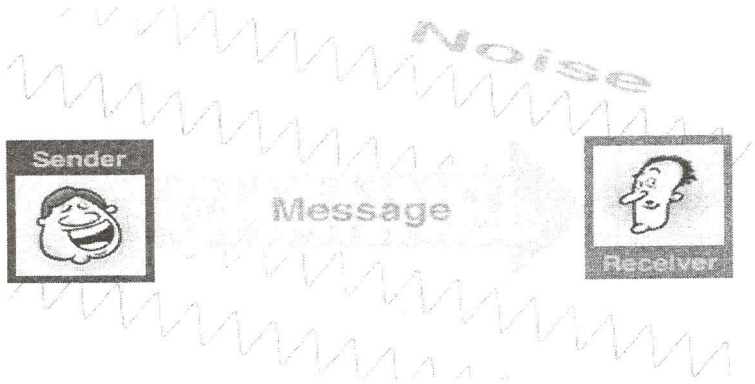
(ii) Arrange the details above as they would appear in the reference list **(6 marks)**

Question Two

A. Imagine you were attending a meeting where the councillor was delivering a speech to community members on good health practices. Generally, the councillor was hated by most people for his strict adherence to discipline and religious principles against beer drinking. Due to this, people were always negative to his speeches. While the meeting was still on, those who came drunk were busy despising the councillor in their low but audible tones. Then somebody's phone bellowed in a loud and long - hefty tone, to the excitement of the entire crowd, causing heavy laughter.

Basing on the above situation, mention and explain any **two** types of noise or barriers that may hamper effective communication in what the councillor delivered. **(4 marks)**

B. Study the diagram below that depicts one of the communication models and answer the questions that follow:



I). What is this theory of communication called as represented in the diagram above? **(1 mark)**

II). Explain why the recipient may not get the message as conceived by the encoder in the diagram above. **(2 marks)**

III). State any **one** example of a communication event that might arise at any institution which may demand message transaction as depicted in the diagram above. **(2 marks)**

C. Briefly explain any **two** types of verbal communication **(4 marks)**

D. Briefly explain any one characteristic of human communication **(2 marks)**

Question Three

E. Distinguish listening from hearing. **(2 marks)**

F. Listening as a process is divided into stages. Briefly explain the stages in the listening process. **(6 marks)**

G. Briefly explain any three types of listening and how you can use them in your study life. **(6 marks)**

Question Four

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

When Americans are bored or have too much time on their hands, an easy solution is readily available: simply turn on the tube. One thing for certain is that Americans are constantly being accosted by an overabundance of television programs. Today Americans have three national networks from which to choose: the American Broadcasting Corporation (ABC); the National Broadcasting Corporation (NBC) and the Columbia Broadcasting System (CBS). These networks broadcast programs free of charge to the public, relying on the support of major American commercial enterprises, such as Coca-Cola and Kimberly Clark, in the form of airtime purchased to advertise their products.

Commercial support is, by and large, intertwined with the public's often temperamental viewing preferences. The Neilson Ratings are statistical indicators which measure such viewing trends by evaluating how many families are watching a certain program on a given network during a particular day or time. If the Nielsen Rating for a certain program is too low, a potential

advertiser will be reluctant to purchase airtime during its broadcast as the advertising message will not reach the maximum number of viewers.

Firms will reach the largest audience during what is known as "Prime Time," the window of advertising opportunity from 7:00 P.M. to 10:00 P.M. Taking the volume of viewers into account, commercial entities devour this airtime with alacrity. A plethora of popular situation comedies, known as "sit-coms," are aired during these evening hours. Other commercial opportunities exist during morning and afternoon broadcasts of long-running talk shows, game shows, and soap operas, now euphemistically termed "daytime dramas."

A. On the basis of your reading of the passage, provide a suitable topic to the passage **(1 mark)**

B. What do the following words/terms/phrases mean as they are used in the passage:

(I) Prime time **(1 mark)**

(II) Sit-coms **(1 mark)**

(III) Day time dramas **(1 mark)**

(IV) Alacrity **(1 mark)**

(V) Turn on the tube **(1 mark)**

C. Which reading strategy have you used to find meanings for the words/phrases in question 5(C)? Give a reason for your answer **(2 marks)**

D. According to the passage, the National networks do not charge the public for accessing their programmes. How do these networks generate their revenues? **(2marks)**

E. Based on the passage, how do you think the statistical ratios provided by the Neilson Ratings affect advertising habits? **(2 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER